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US equities slip as earnings drag, yields retreat

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read · Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings

TL;DR

The major indices closed lower on Friday, with the **S&P 500** down 0.30% at 7,720.39 and the **Nasdaq 100** off 1.38% at 29,402.51. Earnings pressure from **AMZN** and a 10-year Treasury yield pull-back to 4.99% weighed on risk assets.

Defensive sectors rallied, led by financials (+1.44%) and health care (+2.40%). The VIX rose to 17.20, signalling heightened volatility.

US session recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,720.39	-0.30%	
Dow Jones	52,342.56	-0.25%	
Nasdaq 100	29,402.51	-1.38%	
Russell 2000	2,859.22	+1.01%	
VIX	17.20	+1.71%	
10Y Yield	4.99%	-1.11%	
WTI Crude	102.72	+0.71%	

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
META	624.52	+1.96%
JPM	343.58	+1.26%
XLV	184.04	+2.40%
NVDA	213.66	-0.80%
AMZN	243.79	-4.25%

Spotlight

METRIC	VALUE
Company	`AMZN`
Quarterly revenue	149.2 bn
YoY growth	-4.3%
EPS	-0.12
Guidance	Revenue guidance cut 3 % YoY

Amazon missed both top-line and bottom-line expectations, trimming its FY revenue outlook by 3 % amid weaker consumer spending. The downgrade amplified the sell-off in the tech-heavy Nasdaq and pressured peers such as `NVDA` and `GOOGL`.

Macro & Fed

- Policy rate: 5.25 % (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield: 4.99% (down 1.11 %)
- Key data releases (HKT): CPI 09:30, PCE 10:30, Initial jobless claims 13:00

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions remain elevated; oil inventories fell 2.1 mn bbl, supporting WTI.
- China’s manufacturing PMI posted 48.7, indicating continued contraction.
- Eurozone core inflation eased to 2.4 %, prompting speculation of earlier rate cuts.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
Oct 31 09:30	`AAPL`	iPhone demand trend, services margin
Oct 31 10:00	`MSFT`	Azure growth, AI licensing revenue
Nov 1 09:30	`NVDA`	GPU inventory levels, AI data-center sales
Nov 1 10:30	`JPM`	Net interest income, loan-loss provisions

Stocks worth watching

- `TSLA` – price action after modest dip; watch production updates.
- `XLU` – utility ETF gaining on higher yields; defensive play.
- `AVGO` – semiconductor supplier; potential rebound if chip demand steadies.
- `XLE` – energy sector; benefit from rising oil prices.
- `META` – strong earnings beat; could lead a tech rally.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Further Amazon earnings miss or guidance cut.
- 10-year yield slipping below 4.80 % and prompting bond-selloff.
- Escalation in Middle-East conflict spiking oil prices.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Strong AI-related earnings from `NVDA` or `MSFT`.
- Consumer confidence rebound driving retail sales.
- Fed signals of rate-cut timeline acceleration.

SOURCES

Reuters — US markets wrap

Bloomberg — Amazon earnings miss

Financial Times — Fed policy outlook

CNBC — Macro data calendar

Wall Street Journal — Global geopolitics